then told Pradip that he would not take him unless Parekh gave the nod. Parekh relented and Pradip joined CRISIL in 1987.[17]

There was also another Deepak at HDFC, Deepak Satwalekar, a B.Tech from IIT Bombay who joined HDFC in 1981. Satwalekar came from a family of artists. His grandfather was a famous painter and Vedic scholar; his father, Madhav Satwalekar, a veteran portrait painter, was the Director of Art, Government of Maharashtra for many years. He painted H.T. Parekh's portrait which hangs at the Indian Merchants' Chamber from a photograph given by HDFC.'[18] Satwalekar had a 'fascination for small ponds' and preferred to join a small company called Centron Industrial Alliance Limited in Bombay as an assistant engineer. Realizing that those who controlled the purse strings had the power, he decided to pursue finance later, and did his MBA from the US in 1977. He interviewed with Citibank in New York on the condition that they would post him in Bombay. However, he got posted to Calcutta and could never reconcile with the city or the Citibank culture. Satwalekar had heard of HDFC through a friend and sent in his application. He came to meet his namesake, Deepak (Parekh), who at that time was rushing out to meet the Chairman of the Central Bank of India and Satwalekar was interviewed in the cab and the waiting room of the Chairman of the Central Bank of India. His immediate reaction after joining HDFC was that he would now get to write the rules rather than only follow them.[19]

Satwalekar rose to become the General Manager (Finance and Planning), and when Deepak (Parekh) accepted the Chairmanship of HDFC in 1993, Satwalekar became its Managing Director (1993–2000), finally retiring as Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of HDFC Standard Life Insurance Company Limited in 2008. Keki Mistry, the present Vice Chairman and CEO, also joined in 1981 and became its Deputy Managing Director in 1999 and Managing Director after Satwalekar in 2000. In January 2010, Deepak Parekh stepped down from his executive role at HDFC and Mistry took over becoming the Vice Chairman and CEO. Renu Sud Karnad, the present Managing Director joined in 1978 and worked her way up the hierarchy to her present position.

Housing finance was then a new, untried business enterprise, with no precedent to illuminate the way forward. It was an experiment and no one knew if it would work. As noted before, in developed countries specialized